STANDARD 6 SOCIAL STUDIES

Written by Zikomo Masese Banda

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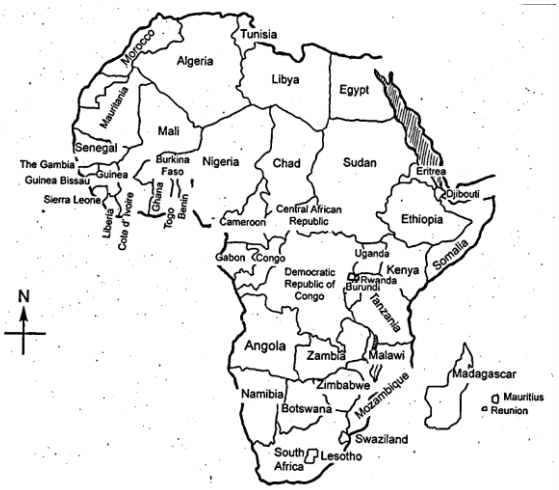
UNIT 1 THE LOCATION OF MALAWI **WRITTEN BY ZIKOMO MASESE BANDA**

COUNTRIES THAT SHARE BORDERS WITH MALAWI

- ♥ There are many countries in Africa.
- ♥ Malawi is one of them.
- ♥ It is surrounded by Mozambique, Tanzania and Zambia.
- ♥ This makes it a landlocked country.
- ♥ A landlocked country is a country surrounded by other countries.



LOCATING MALAWI USING THE CARDINAL POINTS

Malawi is located in the southern part of Africa.

Tanzania is to the north and north-east of Malawi.

Zambia lies to the west and Mozambique to the south-west, south and east of Malawi.

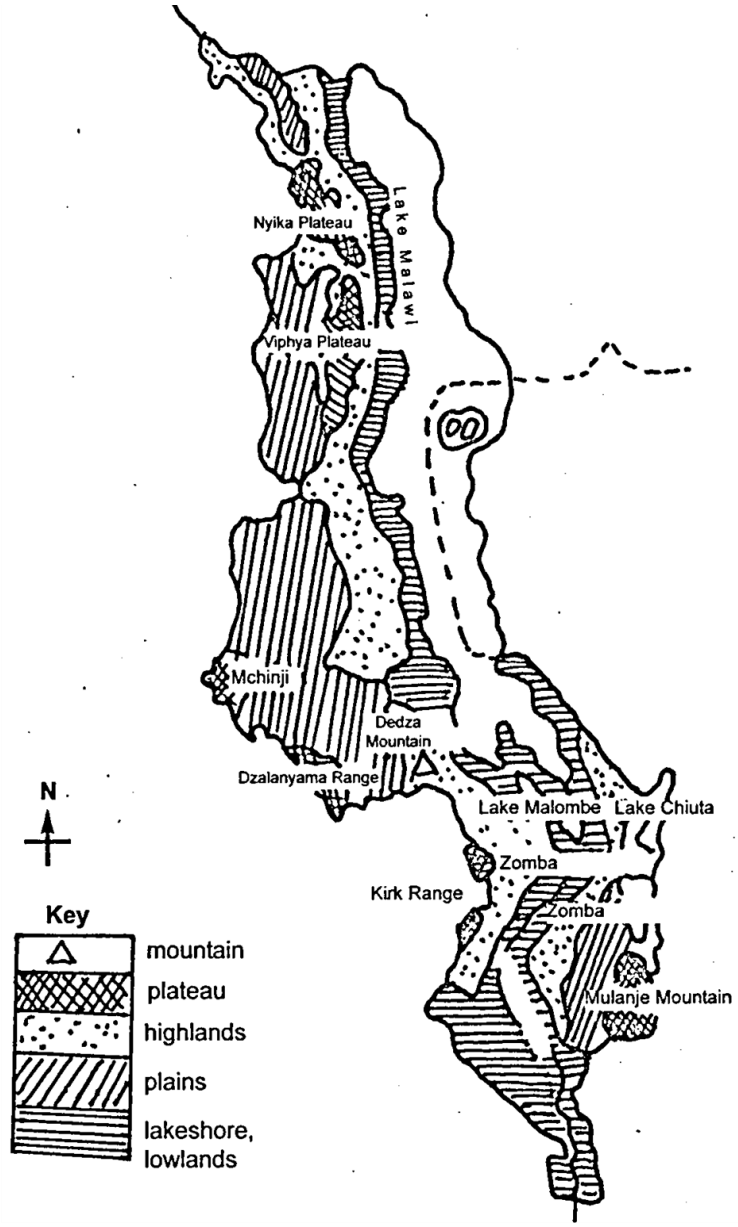
UNIT 2 THE MAJOR PHYSICAL FEATURES OF MALAWI

Physical features are natural features of the earth's surface such as hills, mountains, valleys, lowlands, lakes and rivers.

Or

Physical features are landforms and drainage.

A MAP OF MALAWI SHOWING MAJOR PHYSICAL FEATURES



THE MAJOR PHYSICAL FEATURES OF MALAWI

a. Highlands

The major highlands in Malawi include mountains, plateaus and ranges.

Major mountains of Malawi are Mulanje in the southern region and Dedza in the central region.

Major mountains ranges are Dzalanyama and Kirk Range in the central region.

Plateaus are Zomba and Mulanje in the southern region and Viphya and Nyika in the northern region.

b. Plains

The major plains in Malawi include Lilongwe, Mchinji and Kasungu Plains in the centre.

Phalombe Plains in the south.

Nkhamanga Plains in Rumphi and Mzimba in the north.

c. Lowlands

The major lowlands in Malawi include lakeshore areas and the Shire Valley in the south.

d. Lakes

The major lakes in Malawi are Lake Malawi, Lake Malombe, lake Chilwa and Lake Chiuta.

e. Rivers

The major rivers are the Shire, Ruo, Mkulumadzi, Phalombe and Mwanza in the south.

Bwanji, Linthipe, Lilongwe, Diamphwe, Bua and Dwangwa in the centre.

North Rukuru, South Rukuru and Kasitu in the north.

THE IMPORTANCE OF PHYSICAL FEATURES

Highlands

- Natural forests grow on them
- They provide a home for animals
- They are a source of rivers
- They beautify the country
- They encourage rainfall

Plains and lowlands

- They are good for farming activities
- People settle there

Lakes and rivers

- They are a home for fish and other water animals
- They provide water for domestic use
- They are a source of electricity
- They provide water for agricultural purposes such as irrigation

UNIT 3 THE POPULATION OF MALAWI

The term 'population' means the total number of people living in an area.

Population distribution is the spreading of people over a given area.

According to the 1998 population census, the total population of Malawi was 9, 838, 486.

However, the population is not evenly distributed.

Some districts and regions have higher populations while others have less.

POPULATION FIGURES OF THE THREE REGIONS

According to statistics found in the 1998 population census, southern region has the highest number of people followed by the central region. The northern region has the least number of people.

UNIT 4 THE POPULATION DENSITY OF MALAWI

Population density is the number of people per unit area.

Or

Population density is the number of people living per square kilometre.

AREAS OF HIGH AND LOW POPULATION DENSITY IN MALAWI

A place in which many people occupy a small area has a dense population.

A place where a few people occupy a large area has a sparse population.

The areas of high population density are Blantyre, Thyolo, Mulanje, Chiradzulu, Phalombe, Zomba and Mangochi in the southern region.

Lilongwe, Dowa, Kasungu, Mchinji, Dedza and Salima in the central region.

Areas of low population density are most of the districts in the northern region.

FACTORS THAT INFLUENCE POPULATION DISTRIBUTION IN MALAWI

Population distribution refers to how people are spread over an area or a country.

There are two aspects of population distribution.

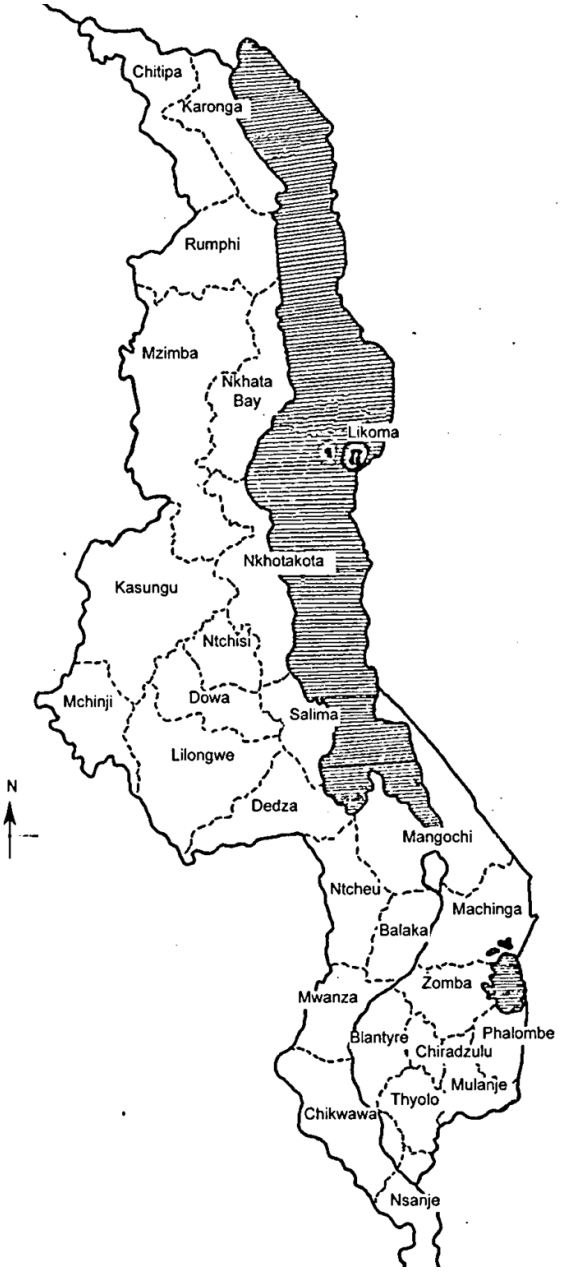
These are densely and sparsely populated areas.

Factors that influence densely population in southern region of Malawi

- Tea estates in Mulanje and Thyolo which attract many people who seek employment
- Fertile loam soils used for growing crops such as maize, beans, bananas and potatoes
- Reliable rainfall
- Trade and commerce and manufacturing industries found in Blantyre
- More towns and townships

- Educational facilities
- Fishing and water supply along the lake
- The sugar industry in Nchalo

A MAP OF MALAWI SHOWING DISTRICTS



Factors that influence dense population in central region of Malawi

- The capital city which has all government ministries and departments as well as some industries, trade and commerce
- Fertile loam soils favourable for the growth of tobacco, maize, groundnuts, potatoes and beans
- Many tobacco estates
- Fishing and water supply along the lake

Factors that influence sparse population in regions of Malawi

Areas that are sparsely or thinly populated include:

- Mountainous areas of Mulanje and Zomba, the Kirk Range and Dzalanyama Range, Viphya and Nyika plateaus
- National parks, game reserves and protected areas which include Nyika, Nkhotakota, Liwonde, Lengwe and Majete.
- Areas with poor soils and no or few industries.

EFFECTS OF HIGH AND LOW POPULATION DENSITY IN MALAWI

- Shortage of land for cultivation
- Depletion of natural resources such as forests, trees, fish and wildlife
- Severe soil erosion because of over cultivation and deforestation
- Shortage of social services such as schools, clinics and hospitals
- Overcrowding in schools
- Shortage of drugs
- Overcrowding in towns resulting into population
- Poverty, crime and prostitution in overcrowded areas and squatter areas
- Establishment of squatter or illegal settlements in urban areas

Areas with low population density may not experience the above effects on a large scale.

UNIT 5 POPULATION CHANGE IN MALAWI

Population change refers to the increase or decrease in population.

Population increase is also called population growth.

A population may increase because of the following reasons:

* Belief in large families
* Preferring male children to female children
* Availability of health facilities
* Improved medical services
* Movement of people out of an area or movement of people into an area (migration)

Although Malawi has a high birth rate, the following are some of the factors that lead to population decrease:

* A high infant mortality rate and child mortality rate because not many people take children to health clinics for treatment of diseases
* Poor health facilities which have few or no doctors and drugs
* Poor nutrition
* Adoption of family planning methods by some families

EFFECTS OF POPULATION CHANGE

An increase in the population of an area may lead to:

- Shortage of land for settlements and cultivation
- Environmental damage
- Shortage of natural resources
- Shortage of social services
- Lowering of living standards of people

A decrease in population may lead to:

- Shortage of personnel needed to develop an area
- Availability of more land for settlements and farming in areas where people have moved out
- Availability of more space for social services
- Better standard of living

SOLUTIONS TO THE EFFECTS OF POPULATION CHANGE

- Adopt family planning methods
- Vaccinate or immunize children against diseases
- Improve nutrition
- Visit clinics and hospitals
- Attend health education campaigns

UNIT 6 LOCAL GOVERNMENT

Local government refers to the branch of government which has the decentralised function of the central government to local communities.

The local government supplements the services that are provided by the central government.

The local government is made up of a number of institutions that operate in the districts throughout the country.

These are referred to as assemblies.

These include:

- District assemblies
- City assemblies
- Municipal assembly
- Town assemblies

FUNCTIONS OF LOCAL ASSEMBLIES

- ☺ Promoting democratic culture and participation among citizens
- ☺ Planning for development of infrastructure in a district

- ☺ Planning for economic development in a district
- ☺ Making by-laws
- ☺ Collaborating with other assemblies on issues of development

Every assembly is headed by a chairperson and a vice chairperson and serves for a period of five years.

For cities and municipals, the heads are referred to as mayor and deputy mayor.

The assembly committee comprises voting members elected from each ward within the assembly area.

It is also composed of non-voting members such as traditional authorities, members of parliament and members of special interest groups, for example, non-governmental organisations (NGOs) and religious institutions.

In addition, each assembly employs a chief executive officer who is responsible for the day-to-day administrative matters of the assembly.

THE IMPORTANCE OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT SERVICES

- ➢ The provision of education
- ➢ Construction and maintenance of roads, bridges, footpaths, car parks and bus shelters
- ➢ Health services
- ➢ Promotion of public health
- ➢ Provision of emergency services
- ➢ Community development
- ➢ Provision of security

Most of the services are provided free but there are some which require people to pay.

The local government gets money to pay for the services by the following ways:

- ♦ Receiving money from the central government
- ♦ Collecting taxes on businesses
- ♦ Collecting taxes on land
- ♦ Service charges
- ♦ Obtaining loans

THE IMPORTANCE OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS

- ❖ Provide services to all people
- ❖ Encourage more contact and participation by ordinary people in affairs that benefit them
- ❖ Facilitate speedy responses from government on development issues
- ❖ Promote transparency, accountability and good governance

UNIT 7 EARLY AFRICAN KINGDOMS

THE NGONI

The Ngoni were very powerful warriors who came from Zululand in South Africa.

They left South Africa in the 1930s.

They fled from Tchaka Zulu, a powerful and cruel king.

They were led by Zwangendaba who died in Maputo in Tanzania.

He was succeeded by his son Mbelwa who led the Ngoni to Malawi and settled in Mzimba.

Another group of the Ngoni settled in the central region.

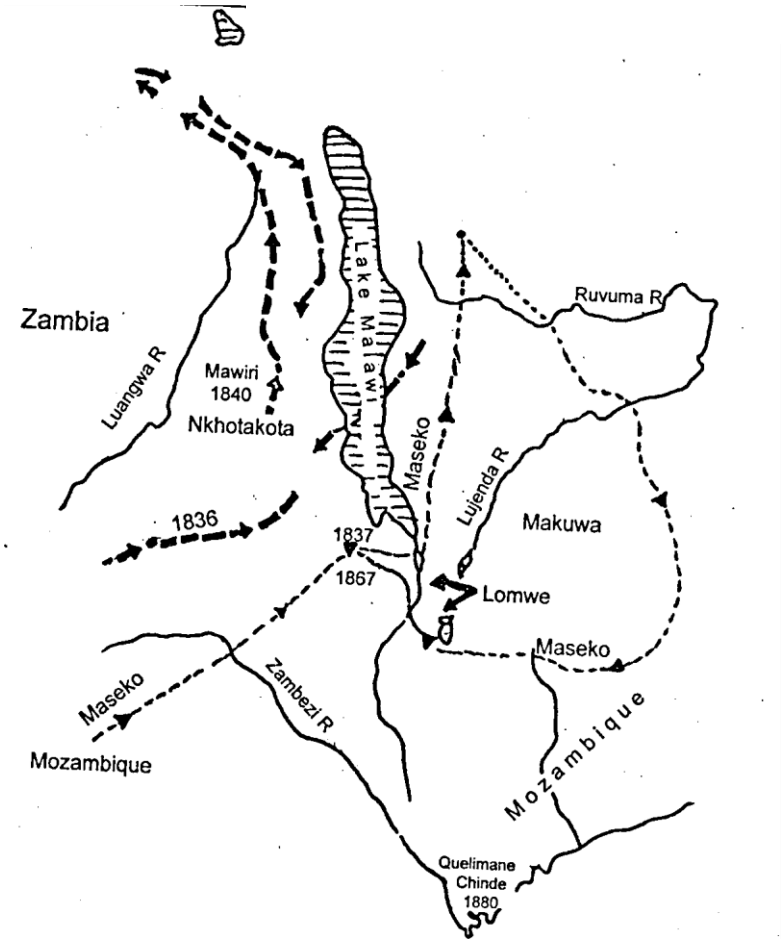
These were led by Ngwane Maseko and later split and settled in various places.

These include:

- The Ngoni of Dedza under Kachindamoto.
- The Ngoni of Lizulu in Ntcheu under Gomani Chikuse
- The Ngoni of Dowa under Chiwere
- The Ngoni of Mwanza
- The Ngoni of Bvumbwe in Thyolo

These people were looking for grazing land and water for their livestock.

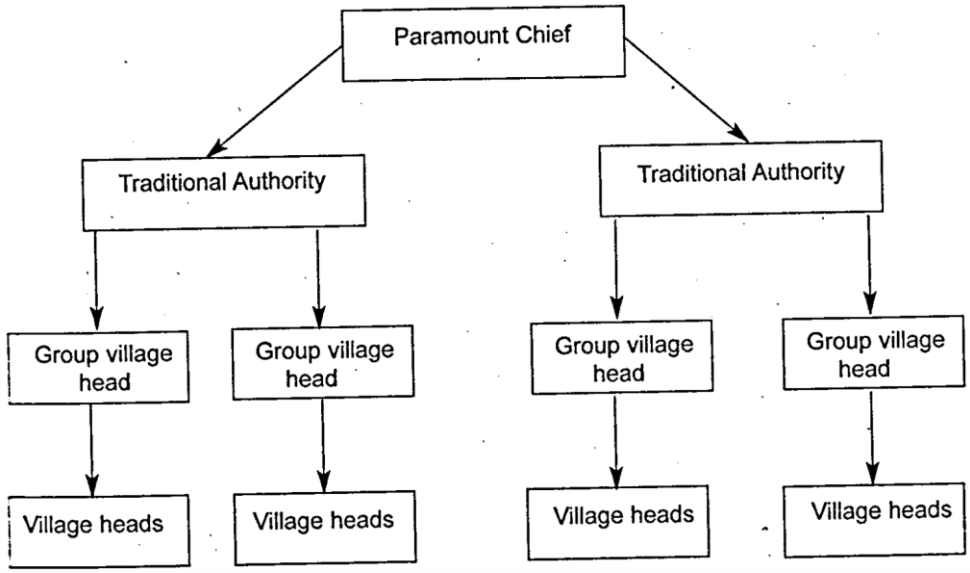
A MAP OF SOUTHERN AFRICAN SHOWING THE MIGRATION ROUTES OF THE NGONI



FACTORS THAT LED TO THE GROWTH OF THE NGONI KINGDOM

- Political organisation
- Military organisation
- Cattle keeping

THE ADMINISTRATIVE STRUCTURE OF THE NGONI KINGDOM



FACTORS THAT LED TO THE DECLINE OF THE NGONI KINGDOM IN MALAWI

- Tribal wars
- competition for leadership
- Missionary intervention
- The death of a strong leader

THE CONTRIBUTIONS OF THE NGONI KINGDOM

- Traditional dances
- The lobola system of marriage
- Patrilineal system of marriage
- Dressing
- Language
- The spirit of solidarity

UNIT 8 EARLY AFRICAN KINGDOMS

MWENEMUTAPA KINGDOM

The Mwenemutapa kingdom was founded by Nyatsimba Mutota by 1450.

Mwenemutapa Kingdom had Great Zimbabwe as its capital.

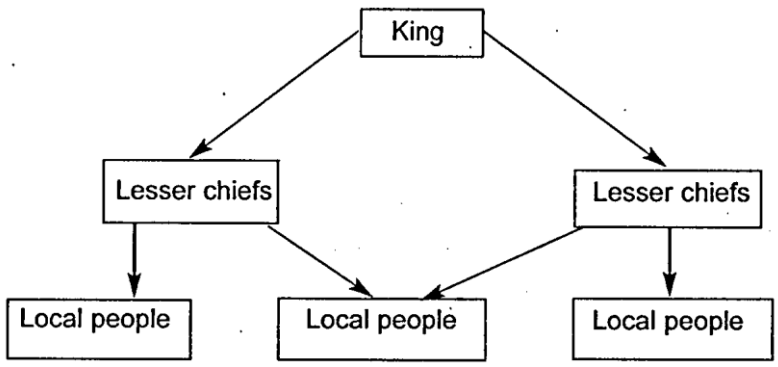
The people of the Mwenemutapa Kingdom were the Karanga who spoke the Shona language.

Their king was Mambo.

He was regarded as a living god and was represented by fire.

He had lesser kings who ruled in other lands on his behalf.

Mwari was the most powerful god in Mwenemutapa Kingdom.



the administrative structure of the Mwenemutapa Kindom

THE FACTORS THAT LED TO THE GROWTH OF MWENEMUTAPA KINGDOM

- Military organisation
- Political organisation
- Trade in gold, silver and copper

THE FACTORS THAT LED TO THE DECLINE OF MWENEMUTAPA KINGDOM

- Lesser kings fought for their independence
- Interference of the Portuguese in the running of the kingdom
- Invasions from its enemies

THE CONTRIBUTIONS OF THE MWENEMUTAPA KINGDOM

- Stone buildings
- Use of iron tools
- Trade with other nations
- Belief in one god called Mwari

UNIT 9 HIV AND AIDS

HIV is the virus that causes AIDS.

HIV is an acronym.

H	stands for	Human
I	stands for	Immunodeficiency
V	stands for	Virus

AIDS is a medical term for a combination of illnesses that result from specific weakness of the body's immune system.

A	stands for	Acquired
I	stands for	Immuno
D	stands for	Deficiency
S	stands for	Syndrome

TRANSMISSION OF HIV AND AIDS

- Having unprotected sexual intercourse with an infected one
- Infected blood entering the body through blood transfusion, syringes, needles or other cutting objects
- Infected persons to unborn child (mother-to-child transmission)
- Breastfeeding

RISKY BEHAVIOURS ASSOCIATED WITH THE SPREAD OF HIV AND AIDS

- Prostitution
- Drug and substance abuse
- Promiscuity
- Cultural beliefs and practices
- Working away from home for a long time

MISCONCEPTIONS ABOUT HIV AND AIDS

- AIDS can be cured by having sexual intercourse with virgins
- Mosquitoes transmit HIV
- ARVs cure HIV and AIDS
- You cannot contract HIV if you have sex with a person with a disability
- Some herbs can cure HIV and AIDS
- You can get HIV by living with one infected with HIV
- You can get HIV by sharing food with one infected with HIV
- You can get HIV by shaking hands with one infected with HIV
- You can get HIV through sneezing or coughing

SIGNS AND SYMPTOMS OF AIDS

Minor signs

- Coughing for more than a month
- Itchy skin diseases
- Shingles (herpes zoster)
- Sores all over the body

- Thrush in the mouth and throat (oral candidiasis)
- Long lasting swollen glands
- Loss of hair texture
- Tuberculosis
- Night sweats

Major signs

- Weight loss greater than 10% of the body weight
- Fever for longer than one month
- Diarrhoea for longer than one month
- Persistent severe fatigue (tiredness)
- Loss of memory
- Repeated abscesses

However, these signs and symptoms can be an indication of another disease.

Only a blood test can prove whether a person is HIV-positive or HIV-negative

WAYS OF PREVENTING THE SPREAD OF HIV AND AIDS

- Abstinence
- Being faithful to one's sexual partner
- Condom use
- Avoiding exposure to blood
- Avoiding harmful cultural practices that promote the spread of HIV and AIDS
- Joining clubs to learn more about HIV and AIDS

THE IMPORTANCE OF VOLUNTARY COUNSELLING AND TESTING

- Knowing one's body status on HIV
- Choosing the expected behaviour depending on the results
- Continuing to avoid contracting the virus if tested HIV-negative
- Receiving advice on how to cope with it if tested HIV-positive

The whole process comprising counselling and testing is called HIV Testing and Counselling (HTC)

WAYS IN WHICH AN HIV-POSITIVE TESTED PERSON MAY COPE WITH THE STATUS

- Taking appropriate steps not to infect others
- Taking appropriate drugs to prevent transmission of the virus to the unborn baby if pregnant
- Eating food that has a balanced diet

GLOSSARY

Abscesses – boils

Abstinence – refraining from doing something for example, sex

Assembly – an administrative structure or institution which is responsible for providing services to the local communities

Birth rate – the number of live births per 1000 people

By-laws – a law made at an assembly level for its function

Central government – the main body of government which has the authority and power to make, implement and manage a country's resources, disputes and so forth

Death rate – the number of deaths per 1000 people

Kingdom – a territory or country ruled by a king

Local government – a branch of government which has the decentralised functions of the central government to local communities

Migration – the movement of people from one area to settle in other area

Mortality – the incidence of deaths in a given population

Mountain range – a chain of mountains

Plateau – a highland or mountain with a wide flat top

Population change – an increase or decrease in a given population

Transmit – pass from one person to another

Voluntary – doing without being forced

REFERENCES

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